

Turtle data format, as recorded by program CARETTA.COM

Last updated: March 2020

CARETTA and TURTLE data formats are identical, except that turtle sightings have a sighting number in columns 40-44, and the rest of the event items are shifted right by five columns.

Sample DAS section (starts below column indicators)

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1234567890123456789012345678901234567890123456789012345678901234567							
35*	111100	090200	N36:46.37	W121:47.58			
36T.	111107	090200	N36:46.48	W121:47.86	16		
37V.	111107	090200	N36:46.48	W121:47.86	e	g	e e g
38P.	111107	090200	N36:46.48	W121:47.86	sb	jb kf	td
39A.	111107	090200	N36:46.48	W121:47.86	650	100	
40W.	111107	090200	N36:46.48	W121:47.86	rh	60	1 1 5
41*	111200	090200	N36:47.78	W121:48.90			
42V.	111207	090200	N36:48.01	W121:49.00	e	g	g e g
43C.	111234	090200	N36:48.60	W121:49.75	last transect was 14;		
44t.	111250	090200	N36:48.84	W121:50.16	16	sb -40	1 cc 2 u
45*	111300	090200	N36:49.00	W121:50.45			
46S.	111310	090200	N36:49.11	W121:50.67	17	kf 73	1 el
47V.	111324	090200	N36:49.42	W121:51.20	e	g	e g
48S.	111326	090200	N36:49.46	W121:51.25	18	sb -46	30 lo zc
1							80 20
49W.	111328	090200	N36:49.49	W121:51.31	n	60	1 2 5
50C.	111340	090200	N36:49.66	W121:51.59	6 feet turtle		

Columns	Item	Format
1-3	Event number	###
4	Event Code	#
5	Effort dot or blank	#
6-11	Time	HHMMSS
12	Blank	#
13-18	Date	MMDDYY
19	Blank	#
20-28	Latitude	NDD:MM.MM
29	Blank	#
30-39	Longitude	WDDD:MM.MM
40-44	Data fields. Information is event-code specific, according to key below All fields must be RIGHT JUSTIFIED within the 5 provided spaces.	
45-49		
50-54		
55-59		
60-64		
65-69		
70+		

Event code	Col>40	Description/Key
* = Auto-position	--	Automatically logged position (every minute)
# = Deletion marker	--	Notes location of deleted entries.
C =Comment	41-132	Notes, corrections, molas, fish balls, etc.
E = End effort	--	Temporary end effort to circle, go over land/clouds etc.
R = Resume effort	--	Resume from temporary end effort

Event code	Col 40+	Description/Key
O= Transect End	--	Use to signal end of transect lines
T =Transect Start	40-44	Transect # (up to 4 numeric characters)
V =Viewing Condition		<i>E=excellent, G=Good, P=Poor, O=Off</i>
	40-44	Left inside (<35 degrees)
	45-49	Left outside (>35 degrees)
	50-54	Belly
	55-59	Right Inside (<35 degrees)
	60-64	Right Outside (>35 degrees)
P =Observer Codes		<i>2-character initials (unique)</i>
	40-44	Left Observer
	45-49	Belly Observer
	50-54	Right Observer
	55-59	Recorder
A = Altitude/Speed	40-44	Altitude in feet
	45-49	Speed in knots
W =Weather/Env.	40-44	<i>H=Haze/K=Kelp/R=Red tide/N=None</i> (Priority when more than one present: R > K > H > N)
	45-49	% overcast BETWEEN SUN AND VIEWING AREA
	50-54	Beaufort sea state (0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5)
	55-59	Jellyfish 0= <i>none</i> , 1= <i>few</i> , 2= <i>moderate</i> , 3= <i>lots</i>
	60-64	Horizontal sun (<i>Clock system, 12 = ahead, 6=behind</i>)
S = Sighting (Mammal)	40-44	Sighting number, numeric only, up to 4 digits
	45-49	Observer who made sighting
	50-54	Declination angle (LEFT = negative)
	55-59	Number of animals (best estimate)
	60-64	Species 1, 2-char. species code
	65-69	Species 2, 2-char. species code (blank if no other spp.)
	70-74	Species 3, 2-char. species code (blank if no other spp.)
l = Ancillary sighting info		Species percentages, for multi-species sightings only
	60-64	Species 1 percent
	65-69	Species 2 percent
	70-74	Species 3 percent (blank if no other spp.)
s = Re-sight	40-44	Sighting number
	45-49	Declination Angle (LEFT=negative)
t = Turtle Sighting	40-44	Sighting number
	45-49	Observer who made sighting
	50-54	Declination angle (LEFT = negative)
	55-59	Number of turtles
	60-64	Species code (<i>dc=leatherback, uh = unid. hard shell</i>)
	65-69	Size of turtle, either in feet or s/m/l code
	70-74	Tail Visible? (<i>Y=Yes, N=No, U=Unknown</i>)

SPECIES CODES:

Also see SpCodesAirDAS.dat

Large whales

PM Sperm whale
 MN Humpback whale
 BM Blue whale
 BP Fin whale
 ER Gray whale
 EG Right whale
 BB Sei whale
 BE Bryde's whale
 UB Unid. baleen whale
 LW Unid. large whale
 UW Unid. large whale
 UC Unid. cetacean

Medium-sized whales

BD *Berardius bairdii*
 ZI *Ziphius cavirostris*
 ZU Unid. beaked whale
 UM *Mesoplodon* sp.
 MC *Mesoplodon carlhubbsi*
 UK *Kogia* sp.
 BA Minke whale
 SW Unid. small whale

Dolphins/Porpoises

PP Harbor porpoise
 PD Dall's porpoise
 UP Unid. porpoise
 DD *Delphinus* (unspecified)
 DS *Delphinus* (short-beaked)
 DL *Delphinus* (long-beaked)
 LB *Lissodelphis borealis*
 LO 'Lags' / Pacific white-sided
 GG Grampus / Risso's
 TT *Tursiops truncatus*
 GM Pilot whale
 OO Killer whale
 UD Unid. dolphin/porpoise

Pinnipeds/Fissiped

PV Harbor seal
 MA Elephant seal
 EJ Stellar sea lion
 CU Northern fur seal
 EL Sea otter
 PU Unid. pinniped
 US Unid. Seal
 [ZC CA sea lion – Usually not recorded]

Other

M1 Small *Mola mola* (<2ft)
 M2 Medium *Mola mola* (2-4ft)
 M3 Large *Mola mola* (>4ft)

Turtles

DC Leatherback
 CC Loggerhead
 CM Green turtle
 LV Olive ridley
 UH Unid. hardshell
 UT Unid. turtle

Miscellaneous (Recorded in comments)

ALBF Black-footed albatross
 FB#x Fish ball (e.g. fb1m, fb10s)
 Sharks – comment
 JFx### - JF species & % composition
 (x = C for Chrysaora, M for moon
 jelly, E for egg-yolk jelly, and
 O for other)
 (e.g. JFC080 JFM020 for 80%
 chrysaora, 20% moon jelly; record
 whenever species composition
 changes.)
 # CP Crab pot (e.g. 2 cp, 10 cp)